



MX-991/U flashlight

Tunnel rats, charged with investigating tunnel networks, were equipped with a flashlight, a pistol, and a knife. The angle-headed flashlights were waterproof and could be clipped to or suspended from the soldier's belt.

Worn down

Eventually, the cumulative effect of bombing, Rome Plows (armored bulldozers), and search-and-destroy infantry operations such as Cedar Falls and Junction City blunted the effectiveness of the Cu Chi tunnels. However, like the other tunnel networks in South Vietnam, Cu Chi was never eradicated. Where possible, tunnels were repaired and new ones built.